



KNOW HOW

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Q I am a new reader of your magazine. I want to install Linux on my computer but have a query. I am using MTS MBlaze on Windows and want to know if this device will work on Linux. I have a ZTE AC2766 modem. Also, please let me know how to use it.

—S. Sen, Kolkata

The modem that you have mentioned will work with most of the current distributions. You can configure your modem using the Network Manager or can use wvdial. Do remember to provide the username and password correctly.

Q I have installed and configured the VNC server on my desktop, which is connected to the Internet via a static IP. Whenever I try to connect to the desktop using VNC Viewer, I get the error message, "Connection refused". I have tried connecting several times, but haven't met with any success so far!

Can you please help me configure it so that I can access

the computer from anywhere, using the Internet?

—Rakesh Kumar, Ghaziabad

If you have configured your server properly, then it should work. The application needs Port 5900 for communication. Please check your firewall and see whether Port 5900 is open or not.

Now, to access your computer, use the following command:

```
#vncviewer static_ip:0
```

This will ask you for the password that you gave at the time of configuring the server. Provide that password and get started with it.

Q I have installed Fedora 13 along with Windows XP on my laptop. Now my laptop always boots Fedora OS by default. Please let me know if there is any way to make Windows my default boot environment.

—Rohan Singh, Nagpur

You can change the boot options by making changes in the `/boot/grub/menu.lst` file. Open this file in any text editor and search for the following word:

```
default=0
```

Please note that the value for the first entry in the Grub menu is '0', the second entry has the value '1', and so on for the subsequent entries.

Now, as for loading Windows as the default environment, you will have to change the value of 'default' to the corresponding value that matches your Windows' entry in the Grub menu. If you have two operating systems loaded on your

system, then as per my understanding, you will have two entries in your Grub menu. Currently, Fedora 13 seems to be listed as the first entry with the default value '0'. If the next entry is that for Windows, it will have the value '1'. Therefore, if you change the value for 'default' to '1', your system will start booting the Windows OS by default.

Q I have installed Linux on my system for the first time. Every thing seems to be working fine. Please let me know the procedure to check the details of my hardware from the command line. Also, how would I get the details of my CPU?

—Sunil Singh, Bhopal

You can use the 'hwinfo' command to get the detailed information about your hardware. Please read the man pages for more details regarding the options.

To get the details of the CPU, you can run the following command:

```
#hwinfo --cpu
```

or

```
#cat /proc/cpuinfo
```

The output will list details related to the CPU, as mentioned below:

```
processor : 0
vendor_id : GenuineIntel
cpu family : 15
model      : 4
model name : Intel(R) Pentium(R) 4 CPU 2.66GHz
stepping   : 1
cpu MHz    : 2666.984
cache size : 1024 KB
```

